

Object Oriented Programming

A Tale of Constructors

IT560



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```

public class Person {
    private String name;
    private int age;

    // Default constructor
    public Person() {
        this.name = "Unknown";
        this.age = 0;
    }

    // Parameterized constructor
    public Person(String name, int age) {
        this.name = name;
        this.age = age;
    }

    // Method to display person details
    public void display() {
        System.out.println("Name: " + name + ", Age: " + age);
    }
}

```

```

public static void main(String[] args) {
    // Using the default constructor
    Person person1 = new Person();
    person1.display();

    // Using the parameterized constructor
    Person person2 = new Person("Alice", 25);
    person2.display();
}
}

```

Guess the language?

```

class Person {
private:
    string name;
    int age;

public:
    // Default constructor
    Person() {
        name = "Unknown";
        age = 0;
    }

    // Parameterized constructor
    Person(string personName, int personAge) {
        name = personName;
        age = personAge;
    }

    // Method to display person details
    void display() const {
        cout << "Name: " << name << ", Age: " << age << endl;
    }
}

```

```

};

int main() {
    // Using the default constructor
    Person person1;
    person1.display();

    // Using the parameterized constructor
    Person person2("Alice", 25);
    person2.display();

    return 0;
}

```

Guess the language?

```
class Person:
    def __init__(self, name, age):
        self.name = name
        self.age = age
person = Person("Alice", 25) # Constructor initializes name and age
```

Guess the language?

Why Constructors? OOP begins at home!

Purpose	Description
Object Initialization	Sets up the initial state of an object by initializing its attributes
Encapsulation	Hides initialization details , ensuring proper setup and reducing errors
Abstraction	Simplifies object creation by abstracting the setup logic
Code Reusability	Enables consistent reuse of initialization logic for multiple objects

Why Constructors? OOP begins at home!

Purpose	Description
Automatic Invocation	Ensures the <i>constructor is called automatically</i> when an object is created
Custom Behavior	Allows <i>defining specific behaviors</i> (e.g., validations, derived properties) <i>during object creation</i>
Overloading	(In some languages) Provides flexibility by allowing <i>multiple ways to initialize</i> an object
Improved Readability	Enhances code <i>clarity</i> and usability by <i>standardizing object creation and initialization</i>

Are Constructors good enough?



What's wrong with this?

```
class Dog:
    def speak(self):
        return "Woof!"

class Cat:
    def speak(self):
        return "Meow!"

# Client Code
def animal_sound(animal_type):
    if animal_type == "dog":
        animal = Dog() # Tight coupling to the Dog class
    elif animal_type == "cat":
        animal = Cat() # Tight coupling to the Cat class
    else:
        raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")

    return animal.speak()

# Usage
print(animal_sound("dog")) # Output: Woof!
print(animal_sound("cat")) # Output: Meow!
```



Explicit Constructor is not needed if no setup needed

```
class Dog:
    def speak(self):
        return "Woof!"

class Cat:
    def speak(self):
        return "Meow!"

# Client Code
def animal_sound(animal_type):
    if animal_type == "dog":
        animal = Dog() # Tight coupling to the Dog class
    elif animal_type == "cat":
        animal = Cat() # Tight coupling to the Cat class
    else:
        raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")

    return animal.speak()

# Usage
print(animal_sound("dog")) # Output: Woof!
print(animal_sound("cat")) # Output: Meow!
```

```
class Animal:
    def __init__(self):
        print("Animal constructor called")

class Dog(Animal):
    def __init__(self):
        super().__init__() # Call the Animal constructor
        print("Dog constructor called")

class Cat(Animal):
    def __init__(self):
        super().__init__() # Call the Animal constructor
        print("Cat constructor called")
```

Optional!

But there's something genuinely problematic!

```
# Client Code
def animal_sound(animal_type):
    if animal_type == "dog":
        animal = Dog() # Tight coupling to the Dog class
    elif animal_type == "cat":
        animal = Cat() # Tight coupling to the Cat class
    else:
        raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")

    return animal.speak()
```

Adding a new animal type requires modifying `animal_sound`, violating the **Open-Closed Principle (OCP)**

The function is limited to the *specific* classes (`Dog` and `Cat`) and cannot handle new types *dynamically*

Mocking or *replacing* `Dog` or `Cat` in tests is difficult because they are *hardcoded*

Tight Coupling!

Decoupling Constructors

```
class Dog:
    def speak(self):
        return "Woof!"

class Cat:
    def speak(self):
        return "Meow!"
```

```
class Animal:
    def speak(self):
        raise NotImplementedError("Subclasses must implement this method")

class Dog(Animal):
    def speak(self):
        return "Woof!"

class Cat(Animal):
    def speak(self):
        return "Meow!"
```

Decoupling Constructors

Adding a new animal type (e.g., `Bird`) requires only modifying the `AnimalFactory` without changing `animal_sound`.

```
# Client Code
def animal_sound(animal_type):
    if animal_type == "dog":
        animal = Dog() # Tight coupling to Dog
    elif animal_type == "cat":
        animal = Cat() # Tight coupling to Cat
    else:
        raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")

    return animal.speak()
```



No longer directly depends on the `Dog` or `Cat` classes. It delegates object creation to the `AnimalFactory`.

```
class AnimalFactory:
    @staticmethod
    def create_animal(animal_type):
        if animal_type == "dog":
            return Dog()
        elif animal_type == "cat":
            return Cat()
        else:
            raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")
```

Decoupling Constructors via Factory Design Pattern

```
# Client Code
def animal_sound(animal_type):
    if animal_type == "dog":
        animal = Dog() # Tight coupling to the Dog
    elif animal_type == "cat":
        animal = Cat() # Tight coupling to the Cat
    else:
        raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")

    return animal.speak()
```



No longer directly depends on the `Dog` or `Cat` classes. It delegates object creation to the `AnimalFactory`.

```
# Client Code
def animal_sound(animal_type):
    animal = AnimalFactory.create_animal(animal_type)
    return animal.speak()
```

```
# Usage
print(animal_sound("dog")) # Output: Woof!
print(animal_sound("cat")) # Output: Meow!
```

Achieving Open-Closed Principle (OCP)



```
class Bird(Animal):
    def speak(self):
        return "Tweet!"

# Update Factory
class AnimalFactory:
    @staticmethod
    def create_animal(animal_type):
        if animal_type == "dog":
            return Dog()
        elif animal_type == "cat":
            return Cat()
        elif animal_type == "bird":
            return Bird()
        else:
            raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")
```

Open for Extension:

- Add new functionality to the module (e.g., new features or behaviors)

Closed for Modification:

- The existing code of the module should not be modified when adding new functionality

A bit about Static Methods ...



```
class Bird(Animal):
    def speak(self):
        return "Tweet!"

# Update Factory
class AnimalFactory:
    @staticmethod
    def create_animal(animal_type):
        if animal_type == "dog":
            return Dog()
        elif animal_type == "cat":
            return Cat()
        elif animal_type == "bird":
            return Bird()
        else:
            raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")
```

Utility Functions:

- Need a helper function **related to the class** but *not dependent on instance or class-level data*

Encapsulation:

- To **group related logic** within the class for better readability and organization

Factory Methods:

- To **create objects** or perform operations that *don't need access to instance or class-specific data*

Decorator

A bit about Static Methods ...

```
class MathUtils:
    def add(a, b): # Without self, calling this method will raise an error
        return a + b

# Usage
# MathUtils.add(3, 5) # Raises TypeError
```

```
class MathUtils:
    @staticmethod
    def add(a, b):
        return a + b

# Usage
result = MathUtils.add(3, 5) # No instance required
print(result) # Output: 8
```



Utility Functions:

- Need a helper function **related to the class** but *not dependent on instance or class-level data*

Encapsulation:

- To **group related logic** within the class for better readability and organization

Factory Methods:

- To **create objects** or perform operations that *don't need access to instance or class-specific data*

Decorator

Meet its cousins - self and @classmethod

```
class Example:
    class_variable = "Class-Level Data"

    def __init__(self, value):
        self.value = value # Instance attribute

    # Instance method using self
    def modify_instance_variable(self, new_value):
        self.value = new_value
        print(f"Instance variable modified to: {self.value}")
```

```
obj = Example(10)
obj.modify_instance_variable(20) # Modifies obj's instance variable
```

```
# Class method using cls
@classmethod
def modify_class_variable(cls, new_value):
    cls.class_variable = new_value
    print(f"Class variable modified to: {cls.class_variable}")

# Static method using no self or cls
@staticmethod
def utility_method(param):
    print(f"Static method called with param: {param}")
```

```
Example.modify_class_variable("Modified by classmethod")
```

```
Example.utility_method("Static call")
```

Animal is inherited by Dog and Cat as “*Base Class*”

```
class Animal:
    def speak(self):
        raise NotImplementedError("Subclasses must implement this method")
```

```
class Dog(Animal):
    def speak(self):
        return "Woof!"
```

```
class Cat(Animal):
    def speak(self):
        return "Meow!"
```

```
class AnimalFactory:
    @staticmethod
    def create_animal(animal_type):
        if animal_type == "dog":
            return Dog()
        elif animal_type == "cat":
            return Cat()
        else:
            raise ValueError("Unknown animal type")
```

Why the base class *Animal*?

